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Forest Society And Colonialism,

- 1) Major and Minor forest Products.
- 2) Maintain ecological balance.
- 3) Provide shelter to wild animals i.e. Wildlife.
- 4) Provide employment to the Tribals.
- 5) Soil conservation.
- 6) Maintenance of the seasons and climate.
Forests are shrinking.

- The cutting down of the Forests or their disappearance is called Deforestation.

- As per the India State of Forest Report (ISFR)

2023-24 → India has 7,15,343 sq. km. Forest Area.

⇒ Causes of Deforestation:

1) Agricultural Expansion → To bring more land in

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Agriculture.

- In 1600 $\rightarrow \frac{1}{6th}$ of Total landmass of India was under Agriculture.

$\rightarrow$ Between 1880 - 1920 $\rightarrow$ 7 million Hectare of land is under agriculture.

$\rightarrow$ At present = 153.90 ^{million} Hectares of land Under agriculture. (1 Hectare = 20 kanal).

2) Introduction of New Crop.

- Jute, Indigo, Sugar, Tea, Coffee, Cotton, Tobacco.

3) Sleepers for the Railway Track.

- Forest were cut for making sleepers of the Railway Tracks.



- ★ ⇒ One Mile of Railway needed 1760 - 2000 sleepers.
- 4) Wood or Timber for ship building:-
- Special tree for ship building was Oak Tree.
- 5) Promotion of Tea Plantation:-
- 6) Fuel for the steam Engine. Fire wood as fuel for steam engines.
- 7) Construction of the dams and reservoirs.
- 8) Urbanisation:- Emergence of new Towns and cities.
- 9) Mining:- i.e. extraction of minerals from the forest land.
- 10) Industrialisation:- Emergence of new Industries from the forest land.
- 11) Laying of the ~~roads~~ Roads Through the Forest.

P.T.O



⇒ Rise of Commercial Forestry:-

- 1) The major and minor forest products have now been sold in the market to earn money.
- 2) British govt. managed the Indian Forest on commercial lines i.e. as commercial or Profit Purpose.
- 3) The British Govt. Invited German Scientist Dietrich Brandis.
- 4) He gave his suggestions for the Commercial Forestry.
- 5) He was made as the first Inspector General of the forest. (IG) in India.
- 6) In 1864:- He introduced Indian Forest Service



(IFS). and Indian Forest act in 1865.

7) Dietrich Brandis also set up Indian Forest Research Institute in Dehradun (UP) and at present in Uttarakhand. (IFRI).

⇒ Features/Provisions of the Forest Act of 1865:-
(or its ~~important~~ impact on Tribals).

- 1) Only the dead or Diseased trees to be extracted from the forest.
- 2) New trees be planted in the places of all trees.
- 3) Trees are to be planted in the straight lines, with a particular type of trees in a particular region.
- 4) Forest officials to Inspect forest regularly.



- 5) No grazing of the cattle allowed in the forest.
- 6) This Act did not permit any Tribal to extract any ~~deprived of their right~~ forest product from the forest.
- 7) The tribals were dislocated from the forest and deprived of their right.
- 8) They could not raise cattle as their means of livelihood.

⇒ In 1878:- Forest Amendment act of 1878.
Divided Forest into 3 categories.

- ① Reserved Forests No forest activity were allowed.
- ② Protected Forest → Very minor and permitted forest Activity allowed.
- ③ Village Forest.



⇒ Who could Hunt Hunt Animals. In The Forests?

- 1) The Wolves, Tigers and Leopards were considered as threat to the cultivators and their crop.
- 2) So poaching of such animals was permitted.
- 3) Those ~~was~~ who hunted such animals were awarded with Silver caps, Trophies or shields.
- 4) An Animal event to kill wild ~~a~~ animals was held and called as Big Game / Big Hunt.
- 5) Between 1875 - 1925 → 80,000 Tigers, 1,50,00 Leopards and ~~200~~ 2,00,000 Wolves were hunted.
- 6) George Jule → Alone hunted 400 Tigers, and Maharaja of Sarguja (Chatisgarh) alone killed 1157 Tigers and 2000 Leopards by 1957.



→ Forest Rebellion:

- The Rebellion in the forests by the Tribals against the forest Act of 1865 were called Forest Rebellion.
- Main cause of the Forest Rebellion was the implementation of Forest Act of 1865 by the British Govt.
- Bastar Rebellion:

- 1) Bastar is a district in Chattisgarh state.
- Chatt. Chattisgarh has been created from Andhra Pradesh state in 2000.
- 2) The District Headquarter of Bastar is Jagdalpur.
- 3) ~~Population~~ Population of Bastar is slightly



over one Lakh.

- 4) Gonds, Halbar, Marias, Murias, Bhatrias, Dhure are some tribal communities of Bastar.
→ speak different dialects and have different cultures.
- 5) They worship Mother earth and some Forest and Rivers spirits.
- 6) They had to pay ~~a~~ some amount for extracting any forest product from the forests of other Villages:- That amount was called Dexsori.
- 7) They ~~had to~~ appointed some forest Guards to ~~protect~~ protect the forest who were paid by the Village.



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- 8) In 1905:- British Govt. dispossessed the Tribals of the forest land and owned the Forests as Govt. land.
- 9) This Forest act and the Forest Reservation Policy became the main Cause of the Bastar Rebellion.
- 10) British took ~~the~~ forced labour from the Tribals which was called Beggar. i.e; Forced work without payment.
- 11) Bastar Rebellion was initiated in 1910 from the Kanger forest of Andhra Pradesh in the Nathaniya Village.
- 12) This Rebellion was led by a Tribal chief namely Gunda Dhur.



- 13) In 1910 → The messages regarding the rebellion were sent to all the villages through the symbols of Chillies, Arrows etc.
- 14) The ~~tribal~~ ^{rebel} ~~adivasis~~ looted the godowns, attacked the ~~hous~~ houses of the officials and even Police Stations and the Govt. buildings were burnt.
- 15) In return, British Govt. dropped the ~~rebellion~~ ^{rebelle} and tried to curb the rebellion.
- 16) The British Govt. finally reduced the Reservation policy to One-Third which was earlier One-Half. and allowed tribal to graze their cattle and collect some forest products from the forest and this rebellion came to an end.

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- Munda Rebellion: Led by Birsa Munda.
- Ramgarh Rebellion: Led by Alluri Sitarama
- Bastar Rebellion: Led by Gunda Dhur.